

Hw 1

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #1

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Part 1:

Since it makes the most sense, I will be working with the Nonprofit that I founded and lead.

We have the Parent name “Tim Traps Cats”; however, we moved to function our marketing under the names of our programs. (Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo MO)

Note: I actually trapped cats outside of The Kitchen for several months. If there are still cats there, they are likely cats that I trapped and fixed around 2020.

I just re-wrote our mission statements, which have been updated on Candid (and our volunteer packet), but not yet on our website. (mostly due to still being a very small team of only volunteer labor.)

Official Mission statement: Tim Traps Cats works to create a healthier and more balanced urban ecosystem in Springfield, Missouri, by providing resources for spay, neuter, and vaccination services for unsheltered cat and dog populations.

Program statements:

Ozarks TNR aims to improve the health and number of homeless cats in the Springfield, Missouri area. By trapping, sterilizing, and returning community cats to their outdoor homes, we will work with individuals and rescues in the community, lower the number of homeless kittens born in our area, and reduce the stress on local rescue resources.

Stop Parvo is dedicated to protecting dogs in our unsheltered and extremely low-income communities by providing access to essential care and supplies. This includes but is not limited to vaccinations, nutritious food, and critical gear. Our mission is to prevent the spread of deadly preventable illnesses. Every dog deserves a healthy life regardless of their owner's financial situation.

candid: <https://app.candid.org/profile/10957728/tim-traps-cats-86-3279982>

Part two:

Job Description:

The Development Manager is responsible for leading the fundraising efforts and building a sustainable financial infrastructure that will support our organization's mission of community animal health and urban biodiversity. This role will have a primary focus on securing resources for neutering grants and outreach vaccination programs.

Primary Duties:

- Be able to identify and apply for grants from private foundations and government agencies, while focusing on animal welfare, urban ecology, and public health initiatives.
- Maintain professional relationships with individual donors by ensuring that they receive personalized updates on the impact of their contributions to the Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo MO programs.
- Both are capable of designing and executing annual giving campaigns, this includes digital appeals, direct mail, and monthly recurring donor programs to help provide a reliable, steady income.
- Cultivating sponsorships with local small or large businesses, pet supply stores, and veterinary clinics in the Springfield area.

- Oversee the entry and tracking of all gifts to help ensure accurate records and give timely gift acknowledgments.
- Coordinate and plan community-based fundraising events and outreach opportunities to raise awareness for the unsheltered cat and dog populations.

Required Experience:

- 1 to 3 years of direct experience in nonprofit development or professional fundraising.
- A demonstrated track record of meeting fundraising goals and successfully securing grants.
- Bachelor's degree in Communications, Marketing, Nonprofit Management, or a related field.
- Proficiency in Microsoft Office and experience using a professional donor database software.
- Exceptional written and verbal communication skills, that includes the ability to tell compelling stories about the Springfield urban ecosystem and animal welfare.
- A strong passion for animal welfare and people, and an understanding of the challenges facing unsheltered animals existing amongst low-income communities.

Hw 3

Amber Paige Perhacs Homework Assignment 3:

Part 1: AI and Donor Persona Development

AI generated:

Donor Persona: Neighborhood Natalie

Fictional Name: Natalie

Age Range: 35–45

Occupation or Life Stage: Local Small Business Owner in Downtown Springfield.

Connection to the Cause: She frequently sees "community cats" behind her shop and feels a "Real Struggle" watching them search for food or huddle in the cold. She wants to help but lacks the resources to stop the cycle of pregnancy.

Giving Activity: Monthly sustainer (\$25/month) to Tim Traps Cats; shares Ozarks TNR posts on her business social media to help "lower the number of homeless kittens".

Preferred Communication Style: Instagram/Facebook updates and quick, impact-focused email snippets.

Reflection

The use of Natalie's role as a Springfield business owner helped ground this persona in the nonprofit's mission to create a "balanced urban ecosystem". I focused the AI on her connection to the "community cats" that are more aligned with the Ozarks TNR program that exists within the entire nonprofit as a whole. The AI successfully identified the internal struggle of a community member who cares about animals but often feels overwhelmed by the process of helping through TNR. It framed the nonprofit as an agent of real change that provides the specialized trapping and sterilization that some community members cannot do alone.

I refined the prompt to shift Natalie from a one-time donor to a "monthly sustainer." This aligns with the nonprofit's goal of reducing stress on local rescue resources through the much-needed consistent support. This persona focuses on collaboration, framing the ask as a partnership to protect her specific neighborhood, emphasizing how her gift provides the "safe journey to the vet" for cats she sees daily in her neighborhood.

Part 2: AI-Assisted Written Appeal

Dear Natalie,

You've seen her. The small, wary six-month-old kitten huddled in the alleyway behind your shop. She is skinny, constantly afraid, and despite being just a baby herself, she is already pregnant. Living on the streets of Springfield, her survival is a daily gamble. Without intervention, her kittens will face that same struggle: a cycle of hunger and fear that strains our community's limited rescue resources.

But there is a way to create a real change. At Tim Traps Cats, through our Ozarks TNR program, we provide a warm, safe journey to the vet where she is spayed and vaccinated. Today, she can be healthy, confident, and free to live without another litter.

Natalie, your heart for our community's cats is what keeps our traps moving. As we head into the busy spring season, we need your help to reach the hundreds more still waiting for their turn.

Will you consider a gift of \$75 today? Your support directly funds the vaccinations and sterilization needed to create a more balanced urban ecosystem right here in Springfield.

Thank Mew for considering a gift to Tim Traps Cats! We are so grateful for your support.

With gratitude,

Ber

Founder, Tim Traps Cats

Timtrapscats.com

Original AI Prompt: Use the 'Tipped Kitten' script and the Tim Traps Cats mission statement, write a fundraising email to Natalie. Use an empathetic but urgent tone. Explain the 'Struggle' of a pregnant kitten and the real change that is provided by Ozarks TNR. End with Thank Mew for considering a gift to Tim Traps Cats! We are so grateful for your support.

Draft Comparison/Reflection: The final version differs from the AI's first draft by incorporating more human-like language and focusing on the real locations, such as "Springfield alleys" and other places where it is likely for community members to see these unsheltered cats.

Part 3: AI Prompt Engineering and Revision Exercise

Version A: Emotional and Story-Driven

Version A. Prompt: *"More emotional and story-driven. You can utilize your story from Homework 1 of Week 1 or create a new story."*

Appeal Version A:

Dear Natalie,

It's 3:00 AM in a quiet Springfield alley, and the temperature is dropping. Underneath a rusted dumpster behind your shop, a six-month-old kitten—we call her Luna—is shivering. She is barely more than a skeleton under her matted fur, her eyes wide with a fear that has become her only constant. This is a Real Moment: despite being a kitten herself, Luna is pregnant.

Luna's life is a "Real Struggle". Every day is a gamble between finding a scrap of food or becoming a victim of the streets. Without help, she would soon bring a litter of kittens into this same cycle of hunger, cold, and fear—a cycle that creates an overwhelming "stress on local rescue resources".

But because of neighbors like you, Luna experienced a Real Change.

Last week, we set a humane trap near her hiding spot. Instead of another night of freezing, Luna began a safe journey to the vet. She was spayed, vaccinated, and treated with the dignity every animal deserves. Today, she isn't just a "homeless cat"—she is a healthy, confident member of our community, free to live her life without the burden of another litter.

Natalie, you are the reason we can "break the cycle". As spring approaches, hundreds of "Lunas" are waiting in the shadows of our city for their turn to be safe.

Will you consider a gift of \$75 today to fund a full TNR package for a kitten like Luna? Your gift provides the resources for spay, neuter, and vaccination services that create a healthier, more balanced urban ecosystem for all of us.

Thank Mew for considering a gift to Tim Traps Cats! We are so grateful for your support.

With gratitude,

Tim

Founder, Tim Traps Cats

Timtrapscats.com

Version B: Data and Impact-Focused

Version B. Prompt: *"More data- and impact-focused. You can gather data from your chosen nonprofit's website."*

Appeal Version B:

Dear Natalie,

In Springfield's urban environment, traditional management—often called "Catch and Kill"—has fundamentally failed to manage feral cat populations. This failure isn't just ethical; it is an ecological and economic reality. Because where there are people, there are cats, and removing a single colony only creates a "vacuum" that is quickly filled by new breeding pairs in resource-rich areas.

At **Tim Traps Cats**, we implement **Integrated Pest Management (IPM)** through our **Ozarks TNR** program. This is the most cost-effective and ecologically viable method for controlling invasive populations. By shifting from top-down "Catch and Kill" to a community-based TNR approach, we achieve:

- **Population Stabilization:** Humane trapping and sterilization directly lower the number of homeless kittens born, preventing the "endless reintroduction events" caused by human failure and pet dumping.
- **Biodiversity Protection:** Feral cats are ranked among the top three priority pests due to their impact on native species extinction and biodiversity loss. TNR manages this impact without the labor-intensive inefficiency of total removal.

- **Public Health Security:** Through the **Stop Parvo** initiative, we provide essential vaccinations that protect both unsheltered populations and our broader urban ecosystem from preventable illness.

Natalie, your support allows us to move beyond "limitless killing with no results" toward a science-based, sustainable future for Springfield.

Will you consider a gift of \$75 today? This investment funds the mechanical, physical, and cultural control methods required to stabilize one colony and protect our local biodiversity.

Thank Mew for considering a gift to Tim Traps Cats! Your support is the "Real Change" our ecosystem needs.

With gratitude,

Tim

Founder, Tim Traps Cats

Timtrapscats.com

Version C: Mobile/Online Focused

Version C. Prompt: *"Designed for a donor who primarily engages online and on mobile devices, not through long print letters."*

Appeal Version C:

Hi Natalie!

You've seen the "Real Struggle" behind your shop—skinny, wary kittens like Luna huddling for warmth. At only six months old, many are already pregnant, continuing a cycle of hunger and fear.

We're on a mission to create a **Real Change** through **Ozarks TNR** and **Stop Parvo**.

How your gift helps:

- **Trap:** Humane, safe capture for community cats.
- **Neuter:** Sterilization to lower the number of homeless kittens.
- **Return:** Bringing healthy, vaccinated cats back to their outdoor homes.

This isn't just about kindness; it's an **Integrated Pest Management** strategy that protects Springfield's urban biodiversity and reduces the strain on local rescues.

Ready to make an impact? A gift of **\$75** funds a full TNR package: sterilization, vaccinations, and nutritious food.

[**TAP TO DONATE NOW**](#)

Thank Mew for being part of our roots! 🐱

Best, **Tim** *Founder, Tim Traps Cats*

Reflection on Part 3:

Which prompt produced the strongest result and why?

I believe that version A ended up producing the strongest result for a traditional fundraising appeal. I think that by utilizing that real moment of a shivering kitten named Luna, it created a narrative that creates a stake in the story for the reader. It helped paint that picture that makes what the real struggle is for Springfield's unsheltered cats. It helps the appeal feel a lot more personal rather than abstract. While version B was informative regarding the ecological failure of traditional management and version C was efficiently formatted for the mobile device, version A just did it better. It was successful in bridging the gap between the donor's empathy and the nonprofit's mission and made an emotional impact on the reader. The appeal helped transform the scientifically supported management style (TNR) into a life-saving change for a specific individual cat, which is seen historically as the most effective way to move a donor to action and donation.

What does this teach you about being "the boss of your AI"?

AI lacks the lived experience and strategic intent of the human leader. It was clear that the AI would default into using generalized information, and without specific instructions to use the

Ozarks TNR or Stop Parvo program statements, the AI just generates generic animal rescue content. By providing some of my first-hand research on Integrated Pest Management (IPM), I was able to teach the AI to elevate the appeal from a broad and somewhat simple "help the kittens" message to a more ecological and science-backed language. The AI cannot feel the "shiver" of a kitten in a Springfield alley or understand the cleverness of the "Thank Mew" sign-off unless I help guide it to include those authentic and personalized touches. In my opinion, being the boss means using the AI to handle the structure, while I provide the soul and science.

Hw 4

Amber Perhacs

Part 2:

1. Key Strengths

The current board of the nonprofit has a strong foundation in most public-facing operations and community engagement. The most notable strengths include fundraising, marketing/public relations, and leadership/motivation, where all board members exhibited these traits. The current sitting board shows a deep understanding of what the community needs. Which is vital for any nonprofit organization focused on local animal welfare.

These strengths can be considered the essential traits for the early stages of community engagement. The current board can be considered skilled in marketing and community understanding; they typically can effectively craft a compelling narrative for the mission of trapping cats and disease prevention. From a fundraising perspective, having three members already comfortable with access to money ensures Tim Traps Cats has an immediate network to tap into for individual donations and helps support grassroots movements.

2. Critical Gaps

The matrix allows a clear picture showing that there are several significant voids in professional expertise and reach. The most critical of these missing skills are in law, human resources (HR), and investment management. Tim Traps Cats currently has zero representation. There are significant voids in resources and connections; the board lacks access to other resources, specifically foundations and corporate support. While they have strong individual networking capabilities, they are missing important ties to media, political circles, and social services.

This gap can directly limit the fundraising effectiveness of anyone on the board. This shows in the lack of foundational and philanthropic connections. While the board can typically secure individual gifts, it can lack the much-needed "insider" knowledge

and access to those introductions that are needed to help secure those higher-level grants from the local family foundations or any of the major corporate sponsorships. This often keeps Tim Traps Cats in a cycle of smaller-scale giving rather than securing larger and more sustainable institutional funding.

3. Fundraising Implications

Tim Traps Cats feels like we are essentially "fishing in the same pond" of individual donors rather than looking to open new doors to corporate and foundation boardrooms. This has felt like an impossible hill to overcome for us; without connections to philanthropy or media, the board often struggles to get Tim Traps Cats's mission in front of the higher net worth individuals or grant-making committees.

The lack of a strategist means that while members are willing to fundraise, they may lack a clear and cohesive long-term plan. This can lead to "fundraising fatigue," where the board works hard on small events but only sees diminishing returns because there is a lack of a high-level solicitation strategy.

As a startup, the board currently acts as the staff. However, without the HR or Legal expertise roles, the board cannot safely build a professional staff structure. This lack of access to other resources means that any future executive director would have to build a grant pipeline from scratch without the board's help in providing introductions to donors or foundations.

4. Recruitment Priorities

1. Reviewing the matrix makes it clear that there is a total absence of legal expertise. As Tim Traps Cats manages property and deals with public safety (such as feral cat management), an attorney can be vital for risk management and liability oversight.
2. Tim traps Cats has very little access to resources like foundations and corporate support. Tim Traps Cats would benefit from recruiting a member who has ties to local philanthropy or corporate social responsibility programs and can bridge the gap between grassroots donations and major institutional grants.

3. There is currently no HR (human resources) expertise on the board. As Tim Traps Cats matures, an HR professional would become necessary to help develop volunteer policies and manage potential future staff. This will help ensure that the Tim Traps Cats culture remains professional and compliant.

Part 3:

Position Title

Tim's Teammates

Purpose of the Role

This role will serve as a vital bridge that exists between Tim Traps Cats and the Springfield and surrounding areas community. You will help to broaden our reach by sharing our mission of humane feral cat management and disease prevention with new audiences. We hope that by building awareness and personal connections, volunteers like you will help secure the resources Tim Traps Cats needs to help keep our neighborhoods aware of the unsheltered cats and dogs and the importance of effective management.

Key Responsibilities

- Actively share the Tim Traps Cats' mission and success stories with your personal and professional networks to help increase community visibility.
- Regularly engage with and share our social media content
- Organize one informal event per year (such as a coffee meetup) to help introduce friends to our community outreach work.
- Identify and introduce potential partners or community leaders to our board
- Assist in donor stewardship by making "thank-you" phone calls or writing handwritten notes and cards.

- Serve as a friendly representative and information resource at local community events or fundraising clinics.

Skills & Competencies Needed

- A genuine alignment and passion for our mission to improve the lives of community cats and dogs
- A desire to learn the specifics of our TNR and vaccine programs to speak confidently about our impact.
- A friendly but approachable vibe and willingness to initiate conversations with neighbors and local business owners.
- Consistency in attending occasional check-ins and following up on introductions or thank-you tasks.
- Ability to work under broad guidance and take initiative

Time Commitment

- We will respect your personal capacity, but will expect a flexible commitment of about 4 to 6 hours per month.
- This is an annual commitment with a mid-year check-in to ensure the role still fits your schedule and interests.
- Most tasks can be completed within your own schedule

Training & Support Provided

- All Tim Teammates will receive a 1-hour orientation that will cover the specifics of our TNR and our disease prevention programs.
- You will be provided with a digital folder containing approved talking points, program statistics, and social media templates.
- We provide scripts for thank-you calls and templates for handwritten notes to help ensure that you will feel confident in your outreach
- The Board of Directors will be available for monthly "Ask Me Anything" sessions that can help you navigate the hard topics within our industry

Part 4

I personally do not have much fear in asking for money to support our mission, it is something that I became desensitized to after years of work on this mission. However, I can recognize that most volunteers will find this direct solicitation to be the most intimidating part of nonprofit work. Fear of being rejected or fearing they lack the technical expertise to justify the financial ask may lead some new volunteers to be unsuccessful.

I hope that my role will help volunteers lead with education about TNR and disease prevention rather than a dollar amount. I hope to guide volunteers into roles of gratitude, such as writing thank-you notes and calls, which is an easy headspace to occupy and a positive way for volunteers to interact with donors without the pressure of asking for money. I am also looking at being available for monthly open-ended question sessions that can help volunteers navigate new connections and ask questions from the community.

HW 5

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

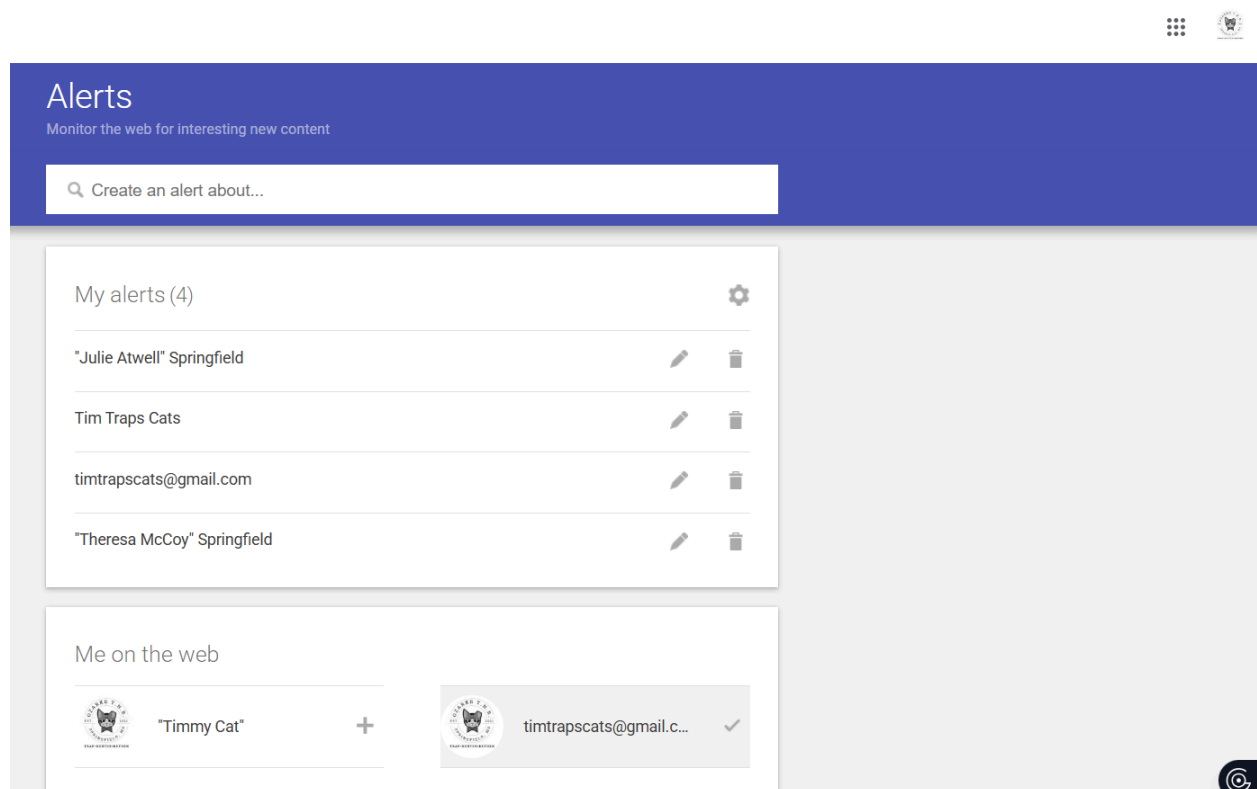
Homework #5

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

1. *Donor’s Name:* Julie Atwell

Why this person is a strong prospect: Julie is currently one of the most significant individual donors for Tim Traps Cats (Ozarks TNR / Stop Parvo MO). As a major stakeholder, it would be important to monitor her community involvement and if there is any additional professional milestones. This will allow our organization to engage in high-level stewardship and help us recognize her achievements. This will hopefully further strengthen her long-term commitment to our animal welfare mission. I find that the most effective way to reach this donor is to engage with direct communication and updates on projects that she directly supports.

2. *Google Alert Confirmation:*



3. *Alerts to Date*

Status: No new alerts have appeared since the monitor was established.

HW 6

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #6

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

1. Core Contact Records

Details: Legal name, nickname, and spouse or partner information.

Contact Info: Physical address for direct mail appeals, email for newsletters, and phone number.

Interests and other info: Specific tags identifying the donor as a Cat supporter versus a Dog supporter, or if they have an interest in a certain outreach program or event. Notes on the donors' connections to certain board members, volunteers, or other major donors.

2. Giving & Gift Tracking

Following the DonorPerfect structure, every gift will be coded to ensure financial transparency.

Such as: Date of gift, amount, and payment method (Check, Credit Card, or Cash). Including a General Ledger to help identify what the money is for. We have separate bank accounts, so it will be clear where the money is intended to go. Using campaigns to identify the why or the overarching goal, such as "2026 Annual Fund" or "Clinic Groundbreaking Event." Tracking which solicitations brought in donations, which helps identify how. This tracks the effectiveness of a specific outreach effort, like the "Spring Newsletter" or "Giving Tuesday Email".

3. Engagement & Relationship Management

Non-gift interactions are vital for long-term stewardship and can be recorded. Some of these “touch points” include: phone calls, writing thank you notes, making notes about local news, and tracking volunteer hours. This helps create a deeper understanding of the relationship the nonprofit has with the community and recognizes the time spent by volunteers on the nonprofits mission.

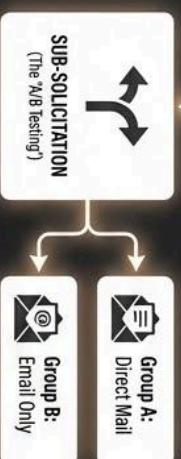
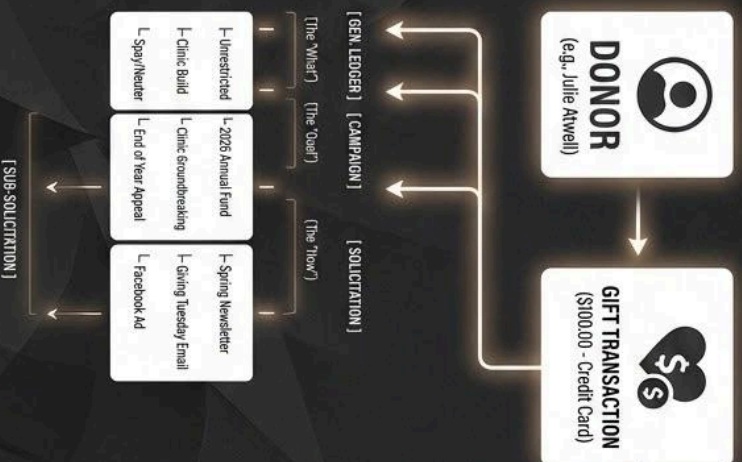
4. Reporting & Fundraising Use

Our organization will prioritize three primary reports to guide strategy:

1. LYBUNT Report (Last Year But Unfortunately Not This, which will help identify donors who gave in 2025 but have not yet contributed in 2026.
2. Solicitation Performance Summary, which compares how the different channels, such as the email-only newsletter group raises money versus the print and mail campaign. In hopes of understanding which method optimizes efforts to raise capital.
3. Capital Campaign Progress, which is a real-time report on the General Ledger code to help track the progress towards any larger campaigns, such as finding a place to build our outreach center.

Part 2: CRM Diagram

DONOR RECORD



[SUB-SOLICITATION]

HW #7

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #7 Part 1

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Use an AI agent to identify features of CRM software

Identify three features you will use in a later prompt:

1. Communication & Engagement

- Workflows that automatically send personalized thank-you letters or tax receipts immediately after a donation is made.
- Integration with email marketing, SMS, and direct mail tools to manage coordinated campaigns across different platforms.
- Built-in tools or seamless integrations for event registration, ticketing, and attendee tracking that sync directly back to donor profiles.

2. Fundraising & Revenue Tracking

- Integrated payment handling for one-time and recurring gifts, including support for modern payment methods (Apple Pay, PayPal, etc.).
- Features to track the cultivation cycle for major gift prospects, managing each stage of the relationship from identification to stewardship.
- Ability to track grant deadlines, deliverables, and complex pledge commitments alongside individual donations.
- Tools to identify and track employer-matching gift opportunities, which can significantly increase revenue.

3. Reporting & Analytics

- Customizable views to track Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) like donor retention rates, acquisition costs, and campaign ROI.
- Advanced systems may offer AI-powered insights to forecast donor behavior or identify "lapsed" donors before they stop giving.
- Tools that rank donors based on their "warmth" or capacity to give, helping your team prioritize its outreach efforts.

Use an AI agent to identify and compare three CRM software packages.

(I edited the prompt to better suit Tim Traps Cats, to say less than \$100,000 a year)

Response:

1. Givebutter (Best Overall Value)

Givebutter is a top choice for small nonprofits because its core platform, including the CRM, is free. It uses a "donor-supported" model where donors are given the option to leave a small tip to cover the platform's costs.

- **Cost:** \$0 per month.
- **Top Features:** It provides an all-in-one experience that includes donor profiles, event registration, auction tools, and email marketing. It also supports modern payment methods like Venmo, Apple Pay, and Google Pay.
- **Why it fits:** For organizations with tight budgets, it eliminates monthly subscription fees while still providing professional-grade fundraising tools.

2. Zeffy (Best for Zero Fees)

Zeffy is unique because it is the only 100% free fundraising platform for nonprofits. Unlike other platforms, they even cover the credit card processing fees, meaning 100% of every donation goes directly to your mission.

- **Cost:** \$0 per month (and \$0 transaction fees).
- **Top Features:** Includes a donor database, automated tax receipts, membership management, and ticketing for events.
- **Why it fits:** If your revenue is under \$100,000, saving the ~3% typically lost to processing fees can put thousands of dollars back into your programs.

3. Little Green Light (Best for Structured Growth)

If you prefer a more traditional, dedicated donor management system that is highly organized but still affordable, Little Green Light is widely considered the best "budget" professional CRM.

- **Cost:** Starts at approximately \$45–\$60 per month (depending on the number of constituent records).
- **Top Features:** It excels at tracking donor "moves management" (the process of turning a prospect into a donor), managing grants, and generating complex donor reports. It integrates well with tools like QuickBooks and Mailchimp.
- **Why it fits:** It is built specifically for small-to-midsize nonprofits that have outgrown spreadsheets and need a centralized place to manage more complex relationships without the high price tag of enterprise software.

Feature	Givebutter	Zeffy	Little Green Light
Monthly Cost	Free (\$0)	Free (\$0)	~\$45+
Transaction Fees	Donor Tips	\$0 (100% Free)	Processor fees only
Best For	Events & Social Giving	Maximizing every dollar	Detailed donor tracking
Learning Curve	Very Low	Low	Moderate

Give me a comparison chart highlighting Communication & Engagement, Fundraising & Revenue Tracking, and Reporting & Analytics.

Feature	Givebutter	Zeffy	Little Green Light
Communication & Engagement	High. <i>Includes built-in email blast tools, SMS/text-to-give capabilities, and advanced social sharing features for peer-to-peer campaigns.</i>	Moderate. <i>Offers automated tax receipts and basic email tools for thank-you notes and event updates to donors.</i>	High. <i>Robust integration with Mailchimp/Constant Contact and a powerful built-in mail merge for professional physical donor letters.</i>
Fundraising & Revenue Tracking	Excellent. <i>All-in-one platform for auctions, events, and recurring giving. Supports Venmo, Apple Pay, and Google Pay natively.</i>	Strong. <i>Simplified focus on 100% fee-free donations, membership management, and straightforward event ticketing.</i>	Comprehensive. <i>Deep tracking for "Moves Management," complex grant cycles, and multi-year pledges. Better for major gift tracking.</i>

Reporting & Analytics	Visual & Modern. <i>Provides clean, user-friendly dashboards focused on campaign ROI and real-time activity feeds.</i>	Basic. <i>Clean, simple reporting focused on transaction history, payout tracking, and registration lists.</i>	Advanced. <i>Highly customizable reporting engine. Excellent for generating "Year-End" reports, LYBUNT/SYBUNT lists, and data exports.</i>
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Estimate your number of constituents (between 1,000 and 5,000) and identify three types of campaigns (based on what you included in your CRM design for homework 6).

Constituent Estimate: 2,500

Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo MO both have separate constituents; a database of 2,500 will allow us to track active donors, volunteers, and service recipients effectively.

1. "2026 Annual Fund campaign." This will focus on "Unrestricted" gifts that will help cover the general operation costs. We can use LYBUNT (Last Year But Unfortunately Not This) reports here to help recapture donors from 2025. I also think this is a good campaign to fund a board matching incentive.
2. "Clinic Groundbreaking Event" A capital campaign focused on finding an outreach center/clinic. We can utilize a "Capital Campaign Progress" report to monitor the progress toward this larger goal as we get ready to expand into a real space that the community can interact with.
3. "Spay/Neuter Outreach" We already have a separate account for spay and neuter. This is important because there are often grants that we get that are restricted to just spaying and neutering. We can also focus on more program-specific fundraising to help keep this account for medical services and

community outreach at a healthy amount. This campaign can be ideal for a sub-solicitation structure, where we can compare the effectiveness of direct mail versus social media only.

Give me a further comparison based on 2500 constituents and the 2026 Annual Fund campaign, Clinic Groundbreaking Event, and Spay/Neuter Outreach

Response:

To help you finalize your selection for Tim Traps Cats, here is a comparison of how the three top CRM options handle your specific constituent base of 2,500 and your planned 2026 campaigns.

Comparison Overview for 2,500 Constituents

Feature	Givebutter	Zeffy	Little Green Light (LGL)
Monthly Cost	\$0 (Free CRM)	\$0 (Always free)	\$45 (Up to 2,500 records)
Data Capacity	Unlimited contacts	Unlimited contacts	Max 2,500 at this price
Best Campaign Fit	Spay/Neuter Outreach	Annual Fund	Clinic Groundbreaking

Campaign-Specific Analysis

1. 2026 Annual Fund (Best for: Zeffy)

- **The Goal:** Maximizing unrestricted capital for daily operations.
- **Why Zeffy:** Since Zeffy is the only platform that is 100% fee-free (covering even credit card processing), every dollar of your **Annual Fund** goes directly to the mission.
- **Key Tool:** It automates **tax-compliant receipts** immediately upon donation, saving you administrative time on high-volume, smaller gifts.

2. Clinic Groundbreaking Event (Best for: Little Green Light)

- **The Goal:** A major capital campaign involving complex tracking of progress toward building a center.
- **Why LGL:** This is a "data-rich" campaign. LGL excels at tracking **Moves Management** (the stages of turning a local prospect into a major donor) and multi-year pledges.
- **Key Tool:** Its reporting engine is designed for **Capital Campaign Progress** tracking, allowing you to link every gift directly to your "Clinic Build" General Ledger code.

3. Spay/Neuter Outreach (Best for: Givebutter)

- **The Goal:** High-engagement community outreach with A/B testing of different solicitation methods.
- **Why Givebutter:** It offers the most modern **social giving tools**, including SMS/text-to-donate and peer-to-peer pages that supporters can share.
- **Key Tool:** For your **A/B Testing**, Givebutter provides detailed **message analytics** to see whether your "Group A" (Direct Mail) or "Group B" (Email) donors are clicking through and converting more effectively.

Strategic Recommendation

If you are strictly focused on **cost savings** right now, **Zeffy** is your best bet to ensure no fees are taken from your \$100k revenue. However, if your **Clinic Groundbreaking** requires you to track very detailed relationships and local Springfield news notes for

major donors, the **\$45/month** for **Little Green Light** may be a worthwhile investment in your organization's infrastructure.

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #7 Part 2

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

In a separate document, Identify your final choice. In 200 - 250 words discuss:

Why you picked the features for the second prompt

Why your highlighted sections (from step 4) were most important for your final decision.

Any other factors going into your final decision.

What are the limitations of your final CRM choice?

Final Selection: Zeffy

The chosen features that I wanted to focus on (Donor Management, Fundraising, and Reporting) directly support the 360-degree view that is required for our diverse programs. Our CRM design requires tracking our donor interests (such as Cat vs. Dog preferences) and our ability to take notes on board connections. These features will ensure that even with a lean budget, our organization can maintain the higher quality touch that is ultimately necessary to help us grow in community support here in Springfield.

The communication and fundraising sections are some of the more important features, as they enable us to compare efforts such as direct mail vs. social media. Zeffy is uniquely valuable here because it is 100% fee-free, covering credit card processing costs so that every dollar that will be raised for the 2026 Annual Fund goes entirely towards the mission. This is critical for us as we have an extremely tight budget. The other decision factors included the ability to track the capital campaign progress for finding a physical location. Zeffy allows us to monitor these specific general ledger codes without the monthly overhead of a paid CRM, which is essential.

Some of the limitations of Zeffy include a lack of advanced moves and management tracking that are often found in higher-tier software. It offers fewer third-party integrations than the paid competitors. There is also less flexibility for unique

data fields compared to enterprise-level databases. Overall, I find that this will all be able to be overcome at this time as I explore having any CRM at all. I think learning on free software is best for now, and I will save this document to come back to when I am ready to look at high-dollar options.

hw 7

1. Use an AI agent to identify features of CRM software

Use the following prompt:

What features should I consider when choosing a nonprofit constituent relationship management software package?

Identify three features you will use in a later prompt

2. Use an AI agent to identify and compare three CRM software packages.

Initial Prompt: I run a nonprofit organization with revenue less than 3 million dollars annually. What are the three best options for constituent relationship management software packages?

(copy the response and paste it into a word document)

3. Follow up Prompt: Give me a comparison chart highlighting **feature 1, feature 2, feature 3.**

(copy the response and add it to you document)

3. Estimate your number of constituents (between 1,000 and 5,000) and identify three types of campaigns (based on what you included in your CRM design for homework 6).

4. Follow up Prompt: Give me a further comparison based on (**Your number**) constituents and **Campaign 1, Campaign 2, and Campaign 3.**

(copy the response and add it to you document)

5. Review the comparison charts and highlight portions that are key to making your final decision.

6. In a separate document, Identify your final choice. In 200 - 250 words discuss:

- Why you picked the features for the second prompt
- Why your highlighted sections (from step 4) were most important for your final decision.
- Any other factors going into your final decision.
- What are the limitations of your final CRM choice?

HW #8

Amber "Ber" Perhacs

Homework #8

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Two survey questions for donors

1. What first moved you to have a passion for pet welfare? How does our mission to end overpopulation through TNR and disease prevention align with your passion for pet welfare?
2. As we look forward to opening our first outreach center, what would you like to specifically see our organization have an impact on for the pets and people in our Springfield community?

Hw 9

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #9

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

What are your primary and secondary styles?

Primary Style: Go-Getter. (Big picture, high energy, creative, quick, and engaging.)

Secondary Style: Rainmaker. (Solidly extroverted with stronger analytic skills than a typical Go-Getter.)

In a few sentences, comment on how you feel the results resonate (or not) with your personality.

These results indicate that my personality relies heavily on intuition rather than deep analysis when making decisions, and I believe this aligns with how I function as a human. This style of thinking allows me to act quickly on my feet and can better relate well to donors in the moment. I tend to think that I only need to understand something deeply when that becomes necessary, and I can apply general knowledge to most topics. (This approach works best when you are also willing to admit a lack of deeper knowledge in the moment.) While this test labels me an extrovert, I actually view myself more like an ambivert; however, I still maintain traits of an extrovert, like my natural enthusiasm and strong energy, which tend to draw people in. I am often described by my peers as “passionate and driven.” This high energy does lead to some specific challenges. I do tend to talk too much, and I struggle to listen closely to others. This is something that I have to manually do, and often find myself putting my hand over my mouth so that I can remind myself to spend more time engaged with the others in this discussion. I also have great difficulty with being fully prepared and planning. I tend to leave everything to the last moment, which can create an unprofessional look.

How do your styles match with the textbook's descriptions of Ambassador, Advocate, and Asker?

The ambassador style matches the Go-Getter's natural ability to be curious about people. The ambassador functions as the "face" of the mission, which can be an easier role for the Go-Getter. (I find this funny because I try to avoid being the face of NP as much as I can, often hiding behind an alter ego named Tim) The advocate style aligns well with the Go-Getter's ability to paint the vision through intense personal commitment to those who are potential supporters or donors. The asker style aligns more with the Rainmaker, which provides the necessary analytic review within extroversion that helps to effectively close on a donation.

What skills or strengths would you need in a partner when working on a major donor ask?

To help me find balance as a Go-Getter style during a major donor ask, it would be best for me to seek out a partner should possess some of the opposite skills to mine. These skills include meticulous planning to compensate for me when I struggle with preparation. They should be excellent active listeners, which will allow them to catch details that may be missed during my high-energy exchanges. A great partner for me should also have an analytic focus, which will help to provide data-driven support for the intuitive that helps bring the "big picture" to reality with real details.

Hw 10

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #10

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Step 1: Build Your Ask Strategy

Donor:

Julie Atwell, a significant individual donor with a long history of supporting Tim Traps Cats.

Specific Project:

Finding a Clinic/ Physical Location

Funding Need

: \$10,000; Which will serve as the initial capital to secure a physical outreach center in Springfield, MO.

Step 2: Write the Ask Script

1. Opening

"Julie, thank you so much for meeting me here today. I've been looking forward to giving you a more personalized update on your donations and how they support Ozarks TNR. Your support has truly been the backbone of our survival. I'm so grateful for you and your time today."

2. Story/Impact (meeting the need)

"We know how your donations have directly impacted your old house and location, and we have been able to make similar impacts in neighborhoods like yours. Because of the resources you provided, we were able to give the gift of sterilization and vaccinations to the community cats. Right now, we are dealing with limited resources, and to truly stabilize our local urban ecosystem, we need a permanent home for our mission."

3. The Transition (leading into the ask)

"We are moving from being a reactive, volunteer-only group to building a more sustainable infrastructure that will be able to continue our growth. We've identified a path to open our first outreach center. This will be a home base where we can process more animals and provide even more services to the community."

4. The Ask

"Julie, because you have been such a champion for these animals in the past, I would like to ask you to consider a leadership gift of \$10,000 to help us create a space for this new clinic."

A pause

5. Handling the Pause--Write how you would handle silence.

I will manually remind myself to remain calm and quiet and take a slow sip of water to ensure Julie is the next person to speak.

6. If They Hesitate--provide 1–2 example responses to:

"I need to think about it." "I completely understand, Julie. This is a significant investment in Springfield's future. Would it be helpful if I sent over our capital campaign progress report and scheduled a follow-up phone call meeting?"

"That's more than I was expecting." "I appreciate that honesty. We chose this amount because it covers the specific needs that will lead to the launch of our first physical location. Would you be more comfortable looking at a pledge of \$1,000 this year and \$5,000 next year?"

7. The Ending-how you would end the meeting based on the ask outcome

"Regardless thank you for your heart for these animals. I'll send a follow-up email this afternoon".

Step 3: CRM Follow-Up Plan

1. Contact Report Summary--Write a brief example of what you would enter:

"Met with Julie Atwell to help illustrate the funding need for a permanent facility . Julie was receptive but requested time to review her finances.

2. Opportunity Tracking—Identify the stage of the solicitation, probability of gift, etc.

Stage: Proposal/Solicitation Phase.

Probability of Gift: 75% which is based on her status as a major stakeholder and current top donor.

Primary Campaign: Clinic and permanent location.

3. Next Steps--List 2–3 specific follow-up tasks you would schedule in the CRM.

1. Send a personalized email with the 'Clinic Build' pitch deck and capital progress report within 24 hours.
2. Set a Google Alert for "Julie Atwell Springfield" to monitor for professional milestones to mention in the next touchpoint.
3. Schedule a follow-up phone call to discuss her decision.

4. Stewardship Plan--If the gift is made, outline 3–4 stewardship touches over the next 6–12 months.

Month 1: Handwritten "Thank Mew" note from Myself or a phone call from another board member expressing gratitude.

Month 4: Invitations to a private walkthrough of the potential clinic site

Month 8: Personalized impact update showing the number of cats and dogs helped since her gift was received.

Month 12: Recognition at the Clinic opening ceremony and a year-end report showing the ROI of her investment.

HW 11

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #11

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Your Assignment: Create a Direct Mail Campaign Calendar for the nonprofit you selected in Week 1 and integrate it into your overall fundraising plan

Step 1: Build Your Annual Direct Mail Calendar

1. March 15th: The Spring Kitten Appeal
 - a. Fundraise for the upcoming "Kitten Season" medical supplies for bottle baby kits and puppy parvo prevention shots. This push will help fund vaccines for puppies at the free outreach clinic and bottle baby kits distributed to shelters this time of year.
 - b. Our target audience will be past donors and local Springfield residents.
2. May 10th TNR Impact Report and Re-engagement
 - a. Share personalized success stories from Ozarks TNR or Stop Parvo; ask for supporters to sign up for monthly donations.
 - b. Target audience will be lapsed donors, which are 12+ months without making a donation and "one-time" donors.
3. Nov 25th Final Year-End Tax Appeal
 - a. This will be our final push to meet annual budget goals; focus on the lives touched by our organization this year. This will also allow us to touch base with our donors for the holiday season
 - b. Our target audience will be our major and large donors and other consistent year-end givers

Step 2: Strategy Explanation (1 page)

I choose the timing of each mailing because it is strategically aligned with the biological cycles of our community animals. This allows for the ask to align with the problem that the community members are facing at that time. These timings also align with some of the peak giving habits that have been previously observed in the Springfield community, which has supported us in the past.

The March 15th (Spring Kitten Appeal) is critical for a "proactive" funding model, which funds some of the major activities that we offer to the community. We hope that by dropping this mailer just as the spring and baby having season begins, we can ensure that we will have liquidity to purchase bottle baby kits and vaccination supplies before the highest influx of vulnerable animals arrives. It also allows donors to start to see some of the problems that exist and allows them to take some action instead of being bystanders in this large community problem.

The May 10th (TNR Impact Report) is positioned in late spring; this re-engagement piece serves as a bridge between the high-stress kitten season and the end-of-year push. It takes place during the break between the highest stress times for trapping cats. We function on two major cycles, and one is spring, and the other is fall. We can talk about what was accomplished in the spring in this push and prepare financially for the fall or second major TNR cycle. This will hopefully utilize the momentum of recent rescues to provide social proof of what we are accomplishing to those lapsed and one-time donors.

November 25th (Year-End Tax Appeal) will follow the industry standard of "The Giving Season, that has previously been successful for us in the past. I often do a donation matching event around this time, and it is a good time for us to run this event and generate donations from those motivated by this. (I often personally match all of the administrative costs for us to function and save all year for this) Dropping just before December allows the nonprofit to capture the 30% of annual giving that typically happens in the final month of the year while providing donors with timely tax-deductible

opportunities. I like to run this earlier than the middle of December, before that final push to buy gifts, and it also allows us to send out a personalized note to wish our community of donors a nice holiday as well.

Our messaging shifts from crisis prevention to demonstrated impact, and finally to community legacy. The tone starts as urgent and logistical, focusing on the immediate physical needs (vaccines and kits) required to save lives in the coming months. Then, we will shift the messaging to soften into storytelling and highlight the success of programs like Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo MO. We hope this will help us create a deeper bond with the donors, and then finally, the tone becomes more reflective. It will summarize the lives touched throughout the year and invite donors to sustain the mission for the future years to come through larger, more major gifts.

It is the goal that this calendar serves as the eventual backbone for Tim Traps Cats' donor retention and helps aid in the capital growth. By specifically targeting one-time donors in May for monthly sustainer programs, the direct mail plan will convert sporadic and unreliable givers into monthly revenue we can depend on. It is also our hope that these mailings will keep our community informed about the projects we are participating. The direct mail dates will also help provide some anchor points for our social media content. This will hopefully ensure that our social media and email blasts reinforce a cohesive message during these periods.

HW 12

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #12

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

You will draft a one-page direct mail appeal letter for one of the campaigns outlined in your Annual Direct Mail Calendar (Homework 11).

Step 1: Select Your Annual Direct Mail Campaign

1. March 15th: The Spring Kitten Appeal

Step 2: Draft a One-Page Appeal Letter

(see page 2)

Step 3: AI Transparency Requirement

I absolutely utilized AI to assist in the drafting of this appeal letter. I think that AI does a good job of digesting the task and guides the letter in a way that most people can digest more easily, while also applying a professional tone. I tend to speak in a very unprofessional tone, and I also communicate in a way that is unique to the average person. I used the AI to help create a more donor-centered narrative that uses a more logistical tone than one focused on emotion, while also engaging in some storytelling and pushing for a community partnership. I walked through the letter and added a more personalized touch to match my personal voice and leadership style, and removed the obvious AI traits that I find to be unprofessional. It is so easy to spot AI writing to me, and I hate that. I think that it is really important to humanize the text and read over it extensively. I also want to ensure the letter accurately reflects the specific programs of Tim Traps Cats, such as the distribution of bottle baby kits and our work with the unsheltered community in Springfield. This is very important to me as I am extremely detail-oriented and care about each letter or word.



[Donor Name]

[Donor Address]

Springfield, MO [Zip Code]

Dear [Donor Name],

Right now, across the Ozarks, thousands of tiny lives are about to begin. But for many community cats and their newborn litters, these births are not a time for celebration....it is more like a race against time and hope for luck in survival

Every spring, our community faces an overwhelming influx of kittens and puppies, and without the right intervention, these fragile animals face the harsh reality of hunger, disease, and oftentimes death. We refuse to be bystanders to this inhumane suffering.

Last year, thanks to supporters like you, we were able to provide life-saving outreach and education throughout the Springfield area. This year, our goal is to be even more proactive. We are currently preparing to distribute bottle baby kits to local shelters and provide free vaccine clinics to puppies living with our unsheltered community.

Will you be our teammate and help us in this mission?

Here are some options that your gift could provide:

- \$25 gets a complete bottle baby kit into the hands of community members
- \$50 funds vaccines for an entire litter of puppies at our free clinics.
- \$100 buys a cat-trap that community members can rent for free

By donating now, you aren't just giving money; You are ensuring that every kitten and puppy has a chance to grow up healthy and is protected from harm. Please consider making a gift today to help us meet our spring goal. Together as a team, we can ensure that every life touched by our organization this year is given a fighting chance.

With gratitude,

Amber "Ber" Perhacs

Founder, Tim Traps Cats

HW 13

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #13

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Step 1: Choose Your Fundraising Model

Designing an Event-Based or Community-Based Fundraiser

Community-Based Fundraiser

The "Alley-Cat" 5K & Peer-to-Peer Run/Walk/Ride

Description: A family-friendly 5K run/walk and a 10-mile bicycle ride through downtown Springfield, MO, passing through areas where Tim Traps Cats has managed community cat colonies. This event leverages the local urban ecosystem to help build a sense of pride and community accomplishment. I think it would be fun to run this as a large group event with a tour guide who can talk about all the local urban biodiversity and point out fun finds on the ride. I also think that we can accomplish this within a detailed map with literature on each location as well, but a tour guide just makes it more interactive, personal, and different.

Step 2: Define Your Fundraising Goal

Total Revenue Goal: \$60,000

Step 3: Revenue Plan

Break down projected revenue sources.

1. Peer-to-Peer Fundraising (\$35,000): 350 participants (runners/riders) each with a goal of raising \$100 each.
2. Corporate Sponsorships (\$15,000): Targeting local Springfield pet supply stores, local businesses, and veterinary clinics.
 - a. 1 "Big Dog" Title Sponsor: \$5,000
 - b. "Crazy Cat Person" Gold Sponsors: \$2,500 each
 - c. "It's raining Cats and Dogs" Silver Sponsors: \$1,000 each
3. Registration Fees (\$7,500): 300 early bird registrations at \$25 each
4. Merch Sales (\$2,500): Day-of donations via mobile devices and sales of Tim Traps Cats gear.

Step 4: Expense Budget.

Provide a best-estimate expense outline.

To maintain that 2:1 revenue-to-expense ratio, our budget will be maxed out at \$20,000.

Budget Draft:

1. \$10,000 for logistics, which will include: applying for city permits, hiring police security for the route closures, and renting portable restrooms.
2. \$4,000 for marketing and tech, which includes Eventbrite or another software and their fees, purchasing social media ads, and printing of route maps and other literature.
3. \$3,500 for participant merch, which will include pre-printed T-shirts with sponsor logos and medals for those who complete the 5K Run/Walk/Ride.
4. \$2,500 for food and entertainment, which includes post-race snacks, several water stations, and a local DJ to help create a fun and welcoming atmosphere.

Step 5: Key Strategic Planning Considerations

Address the application of concepts from Chapters 12 & 13.

- I will separate the logistics team and the fundraising team. I can lead the fundraising and major donor outreach, while another board member will be assigned solely to logistics, making sure the event runs safely and on schedule.
- We will use an early sign-up incentive to combat low ticket sales and generate hype. A 20% early bird discount will be offered for the first two weeks of registration to drive that initial momentum.
- I will help provide participants with a peer-to-peer toolkit containing email templates and education materials that will help them gain confidence and overcome the fear of asking their friends for a donation. This will be marketed with the sale of entry as an excellent opportunity to also learn how to be a teammate for your community.

Step 6: CRM Integration Plan

Explain how this event and related activity would be documented in your CRM (refer back to your Homework 6 design).

We will be using Zeffy as our CRM platform. We plan to take the attendees from the event and integrate them into our donor software. All event registration data will be synced with existing donor profiles. Anyone who gets flagged as a new participant will have a note added to their profile as "Prospectful Donors" for our organization. Based on their registration choices, we will make notes in their donor profile to say if they are more likely to support our dog or cat programs. To maintain financial transparency and analyze the event's return on investment, all

incoming donations will be coded under the "Alley-Cat 5K" solicitation code to know where these potential donors were sourced.

After the event, (ideally) the CRM will automatically send a personalized "Thank Mew" tax receipts and a post-event survey to help capture feedback on the event. We will make sure that there is a note or flag on anyone who succeeded exceptionally in their peer-to-peer fundraisers. Those who exceed \$1,000 in total donations will be thanked as top performers. These top-performers will receive personal follow-up calls from the board to cultivate them as potential major donors for the future.

AI Transparency: I utilized AI to assist in calculating and building a budget plan that created estimates for some of the costs and revenues

Midterm

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Midterm

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Part 1:

Paper Assignment: Understanding Generational Giving

It is well understood that successful long-term fundraising often will depend on being able to recognize how generational differences show up in philanthropy. This is rather than taking an approach that relies on a one-size-fits-all. Tim Traps Cats' sustainability requires balancing the retention of older loyal donors while also cultivating the younger supporters who will contribute more as they age. This is sometimes hard to remember when you are first starting out, but it becomes more essential as the nonprofit grows.

The Older Generations, such as the Baby Boomers and Seniors, are currently the backbone of giving. This group of people represents 43% and 26% of total charitable donations, respectively. (Which comes out to 69% of all donors!) It is stated in the reading that seniors remain the most responsive to direct mail and telemarketing, but Boomers have shifted, becoming just as likely to give online as via mail. I realized that we often do not market to the seniors at all within the nonprofit; we do not have events for them or any type of mailing for donations. For Tim Traps Cats, engaging these groups involves emphasizing the immediate impact of monetary donations, as nearly half of these donors view financial gifts as their most impactful contribution. We do this primarily through online networking. If we do talk to senior donors, we often only receive donations from in-person conversations, which is similar to what is

stated in the text: they will donate more when they hear from high-authority figures within the organization.

The younger generations of donors, which include Gen X, Millennials, and Gen Z, are far more likely to give online when donating. Millennials represent 11% of giving, have a good understanding of online marketing, and are the most likely to spread a nonprofit's message through social media. They will often prioritize transparency within the organization and want to witness the impact the organization makes firsthand. In order for Tim Traps Cats to engage with this generations we utilize social media as an engagement tool to encourage peer-to-peer advocacy and crowdfunding. This has been the most effective way we have fundraised in the past, and it is the lifeline of our organization.

In order for us to strengthen our donor relationships, we should practice tracking the age of our donors. This can be done in a CRM and will help to segment communications effectively. We can implement something called a "ladder of engagement". This is where donors can move from supporters on social media interaction with supporters to attending events and then to eventually making donations. Tim Traps Cats hopes to be able to seamlessly guide potential donors on a journey toward long-term commitment to our nonprofit.

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Campbell Piercy

Tim Traps Cats

Part 2:

Role-Play “Making the Ask”

During the role-play, I felt a little awkward, but I successfully utilized "the power of the ask". I did this by grounding the request in the Julies's specific history with our organization. She was one of my first real donors and has worked with me from the conception of this organization. I feel like I was clear in my articulation of the transition from a "reactive volunteer-only group" to creating a "sustainable infrastructure," which aligns intending to show donors a clear growth path. I also felt my transition into the \$10,000 leadership gift request was direct. I sometimes view my directness as a flaw, but sometimes it can also be a positive aspect of my personality. When reviewing the recording, I noticed several non-verbal cues, like touching my face, which could have signaled to the donor that I have discomfort with the high dollar amount. I struggle with this type of formal interaction as I am on the autism spectrum. In the future, I want to practice more with "sitting in the silence" after the ask to give the donor more space to respond without me feeling the need to fill the gap as I often do.

I think that my partner did an excellent job establishing the critical skills of a fundraiser by clearly defining that the Missouri Institute of Natural Science's unique position as the only natural history museum in the Springfield region with real dinosaur fossils. His request for \$100,000 for a museum addition was bold while also well-framed as a community investment for "the children of the Ozarks." I think that the script felt more like a speech to me, but I am not

sure if that was intentional. I tried to work my script into a more natural conversation so there was mayn differences to how we approached this assignment. To improve, he could incorporate more budget planning by explaining exactly how many additional children or field trips that specific dollar amount would facilitate. I think these details will amplify his ask, and this would appeal directly to the generational preference for seeing tangible results from a major gift.

Grad/proj

Memorandum

TO: Dr. Katie

FROM: Amber Paige Perhacs

DATE: 4/7/2026

SUBJECT: SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising; Attracting more Volunteers

This memo will go over the graduate project that is geared towards generating more volunteers for the nonprofit Tim Traps Cats. Volunteers are our best donors, so by attracting volunteers, we are creating a larger base to fundraise from. I want to accomplish this by creating a better foundation that will hopefully create a welcoming environment that also has structure. I will also use some simple recruiting techniques to attract a wide variety of volunteers.

Facebook

I will start a private group that will be used to keep volunteers informed and connected. This group will be used to post volunteer opportunities and post various training that will be offered. I will also use this group to help generate volunteers for events. I will also work on another group that is for our followers to post in. This group will help connect our community of “feral cat feeders” and may be a source for pet recovery. This group will also act as a board to help inform our most dedicated followers about events and local services, as the Facebook algorithm prioritizes group posts over page posts. I will remain active on these pages weekly so that I can continue to grow them.

Trainings

Recently, I have started requiring an introductory training for all new volunteers. This training is to help new volunteers navigate the training manual and also gives a 15-20 lecture that goes over the science behind our mission statements and educates volunteers on talking points for why pest management preserves biodiversity and how our programs are supported by scientific studies. I would like to work on making slides that are more direct to the point, and maybe clean them up some more. I want the training to go over my suggested ethics, volunteer commitments (reporting), and the science of pest management. (Yes, cats and dogs are pests. This is just the correct wording, but I think it can be replaced by pet management as well)

Board Postings

Other people who provide professional services for free would be ideal volunteers for this organization to attract. Some of these would be pre-vet students for vaccine clinic help, or marketing students to manage your social media. Other volunteers that would be great for us to attract would be potential board members who come with wealth, wisdom, or will work. Ideal persons for this would be local professionals (lawyers, HR managers) who can give Tim Traps Cats the legal and structural support that we need to grow. I want to do this by spending some time posting on boards that are separate from Facebook. I would need to find the boards and research them, and would like to consider this research as part of this project.

Website

I have our website out for updates to a very talented person, but it is taking a long time to come back. I want to do some research on other options for the updates that are desperately needed for our website. I know that our website is the first stop for volunteers and donors, and it really, really needs a makeover. This is beyond urgent and needs to be done. I want to update my progress or research on this topic in this project.

Conclusion

This proposed project will include progress updates on the four topics listed in this memo. I will provide updates on the expansion and postings in the two Facebook groups that are supported by Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo. I will ask Dr. Katie to attend one of the upcoming trainings to be provided with feedback on the educational materials. I will complete research on where to post for volunteers that will attract different types of professionals to apply to become volunteers. I will get a progress report for our website, or I will start my efforts towards a new direction to get the website updated. If you have any questions about my plans, please email me at perhacs811@live.missouristate.edu .

Tab 23

Memorandum

TO: Dr. Katie

FROM: Amber Paige Perhacs

DATE: 5/4/2026

SUBJECT: SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising; Attracting more Volunteers Reflection

This memo will go over the graduate project reflection. This reflection will talk about that ways I looked into to help the nonprofit, Tim Traps Cats generate more volunteers. The goal of this project was to assess ways to attract volunteers since they are our best donors, and the backbone of fundraising. This project's goal was aimed to create a better volunteer foundation that will hopefully create a welcoming environment that also has structure. I spent time on several topics that I believe will help recruit a wide variety of new volunteers. I also spent time talking to current volunteers and looking for ways to engage with existing volunteers.

Facebook

I will start a private group that will be used to keep volunteers informed and connected. This group will be used to post volunteer opportunities and post various training that will be offered. I will also use this group to help generate volunteers for events. I will also work on another group that is for our followers to post in. This group will help connect our community of “feral cat feeders” and may be a source for pet recovery. This group will also act as a board to help inform our most dedicated followers about events and local services, as the Facebook algorithm prioritizes group posts over page posts. I will remain active on these pages weekly so that I can continue to grow them.

HW 14

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #14

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Review 3 donation pages, including:

- *First Impression & User Experience*
- *Messaging*
- *Design & Functionality*
- *Alignment with Best Practices*
- *Overall Effectiveness*

1. Rescue One: <https://secure.qgiv.com/for/rescueone>

- a. The page leads with a powerful collage of rescue animals in need, which connects you to their purpose immediately. Their page utilizes a clear list of suggested amounts and offers a "Monthly Giving Program", dedicating space to encourage recurring giving.
- b. The messaging is very clear and explicitly states how the donation makes an impact. This can be seen by the line "\$50 supports spay/neuter and medical care." This really creates a concrete incremental difference that a donation will make.
- c. The page offers modern payment options, including PayPal, Venmo, and standard credit cards. The page also takes time to include secondary ways to help or donate, such as listing the Amazon Wish List and physical donation drop-off locations.
- d. The interface is streamlined and will ensure that from the moment a donor decides to give, they can do so in fewer than three clicks.
- e. Rescue One's donation page is highly effective and is a textbook example of modern nonprofit fundraising.

2. HavaHeart Rescue: <https://havaheartrescue.org/donate>

- a. The page uses some high-quality imagery of rescued dogs, which follows the recommendation to include "close-ups of people or animals" to create an emotional connection.

- b. The language is simple and avoids technical jargon, focusing instead on the direct action of donating. However, it lacks impact examples that can double online revenue from this page.
 - c. The large, touch-friendly buttons for Venmo and PayPal suggest the design was made with mobile donors in mind.
 - d. While the page offers many easy ways to give, it lacks a prominent feature for a recurring or monthly gifting option on the main landing page, which can increase a donor's lifetime.
 - e. HavaHeart Rescue's donation page is effective and has a highly accessible and visually appealing donation landing page.
3. Tim Traps Cats: <https://timtrapscats.com/donate>
- a. Unlike the other organizations reviewed, this page lacks imagery, and the initial landing page is extremely sparse, featuring only a single PayPal "Donate" button. It is more or less super sad. This was once a proud page of mine because it just existed. I do have the website out to a friend who is making progress.
 - b. The messaging is focused entirely on the transaction: "Use PayPal to donate to Tim Traps Cats." The page does not communicate who we are, what we do, or why it matters. There are no specific impact examples.
 - c. It successfully offers modern, low-friction payment options via the PayPal portal, including Venmo and Debit/Credit cards. However, it is nearly empty, and it fails to use any bold imagery to grab attention.
 - d. The organization succeeds at using fewer than 3 clicks to payment; it actually only takes two clicks (one on the site, one on the portal) to reach the final payment step. However, it really fails when the donor encounters a blank "\$0" field. This creates decision paralysis because we really fail to guide appropriate donation amounts.
 - e. Tim Traps Cats' donation page needs improvement and fails to inspire donations.

HW 15

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #15

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

1. Overview

- a. We want to load our spay and neuter account with funds to perform the needed surgeries now. We aim to prevent the birth of hundreds of homeless kittens this summer, which will directly reduce the stress on local shelters.
 - i. *What is the purpose of the campaign?* An annual campaign that helps kick-start one of the busier times of year for our organization. This also funds a specific program.
 - ii. *Who is your target audience?* Current donors and Springfield residents who have used our TNR services, and other community members, are concerned about the local cat population increasing.
 - iii. *What is the goal?* \$5,000 to fund the sterilization and vaccination of 99 community cats within 30 days

2. Email Content

- a. First Email
 - i. *Subject line:* 99 cats, 1 goal: Stop kitten season before it starts!
 - ii. *Message:* Spring is just around the corner, and in the world of cat rescue, that means one thing: thousands of homeless kittens! The season is coming as it does every year, and our shelters are already overwhelmed. It doesn't have to be this way. With your support, Ozarks TNR can help relieve this yearly problem. We know that the most effective way to help is through the management project called: Trap-Neuter-Return (TNR). We are launching our " We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one." That will help fix 99 community cats in the next 30 days. This proactive effort will prevent thousands of unwanted births in Springfield and the surrounding area. We have the traps and the volunteers, we just need the funding!

- iii. *Call to Action:* Donate \$50 to sponsor one cat's surgery and vaccines

b. Email 2

- i. Subject line: Meet Jimothy: Why your support matters
- ii. Message: Last month, we trapped Jimothy, who was a pitiful and weathered tomcat who had been struggling with fights within his neighborhood in Springfield for years. Because of donors like you, we were able to get him neutered, vaccinated, and treat him for a minor infection. Today, Jimothy has returned home and is living his best life, no longer fighting for territory and living peacefully amongst his colony mates. There are dozens of "Jimothys" currently on our waiting list. Your contribution allows for us to help these cats live healthier lives. But that's not all, you are also helping us manage the community cat population humanely. A small gift today makes a massive difference in a street cat's life.
- iii. *Call to Action:* Give today to help the cats on our waiting list

c. Final Email

- i. *Subject line:* Final 48 hours! We're only \$1,150 away.
- ii. *Message:* We are just so close to fixing 99 cats! Thanks to the incredible generosity of our community, we have already funded surgeries for 76 cats, WOW! We are just overjoyed by those who choose to support us in the mission: "We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one." We only have 48 hours left in our Spring Sprint to reach our goal of 99 cats. Can you help us cross the finish line? Every dollar raised goes directly to spay or neuter costs. Let's work together to ensure that every community cat works towards keeping Springfield's kitten population under control this year.
- iii. *Call to Action:* " We have 23 problems left, can you Spay 1?"

HW 16

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #16

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Part 1: Social Media Assessment (1 page minimum, 2 pages maximum)

- What platforms are they using?
 - We primarily use facebook. We have a instagram and a tiktok as well. I just genuinely really am poor at managing social media. I say that but I think that I really deeply struggle with agoraphobia and social anxiety to an level that is literally a disability. Social media is very challenging for me, but I am not “poor” at it.
- What types of content are they posting? (stories, statistics, events, donor recognition, etc.)
 - Our content had varied over the years. I think that I have the confidence to post now more than ever, but I am just not on the field anymore. I have been trying really hard to collect pictures and videos from volunteers, but it is difficult. I also still have my social media hang up, so getting content from others makes me feel insecure on if they would be okay if I posted it. I am not sure if that makes sense. I do however view social media as one of the main ways to generate income for what I do. We post urgent lows or needs. I need to back away from this and post for educational material. However, it is still very difficult for me. We do post stats and events. I have found that often my donors absolutely do not want to be posted, that has been a really common theme for most of my bigger donors. Which makes it hard to post them, however I really want to make sure everyone is okay with getting posted.
- What appears to be working well? (engagement, consistency, messaging)
 - We made the most money off of facebook, when I was actively trapping. I just could not bring that much in anymore because I am just not going out and doing TNR like I used too. I can not. It also was not a big enough income stream to even support my efforts and expand at all. It was weird.
- Where are there gaps or missed opportunities?

- Absolutely! My consistency is trash. I do not post enough education or successful stories. The content is authentic, but it just lacks a consistent visual brand. I want to hire an employee that was social competent, or even someone who wanted to work along side me with it, to really help be get through my disabled road bump.
- How well does their content reflect donor-centered messaging and mission impact?
 - I think that we talk to our donors well, but we should post more often or atleast mote consistently.

○

Part 2: Social Media Strategy (1 page minimum, 3 pages maximum)

The 99 Problems Campaign: “We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one!”

- *Target audience(s)*
 - Local business owners and residents who care about community cats but feel overwhelmed by the cycle of pregnancy. Students, both of highschool and college ages. I think this is a good age to influence learners and create habits for long term functioning adults
- *Primary goal (awareness, engagement, fundraising, volunteer recruitment, etc.)*
 - Fundraising and Awareness. Specifically, raising **\$5,000 to fix 99 community cats** in 30 days, but I also think this campaign on social media would also do well in promoting an online education opportunity. I do not just want to raise money, but I also want to get learners into education so that when they are able to donate they understand why our mission is important to begin with.
- *Key messaging themes*
 - One un-spayed female cat leads to dozens of kittens; while this is true it just scratches the surface. Management of pets outdoors is a community effort and education and policies need to be in place for this concept to be applied. You can not empty the ocean with a mop, but you can build a bigger pump over time with enough resources.
 - TNR as a tool for biodiversity and urban ecosystem balance. (Trap Neuter and Return) TNR is part of a great system called integrated pest management and actually is a niche within a conversation effort.
- *Recommended platforms and why*
 - **Facebook because it is easy for us to** leverage our already established groups and spread awareness through our following.
 - **Instagram (ortiktok) because this is the best place to** To share short videos (Reels) under 3 minutes, which can raise **800% more money** than photo-only posts. I just have to come up with a good video series to do.
- *Posting frequency*

- Post at least daily on Facebook and Instagram during the campaign's "Spring Sprint". Utilize the "Burrito Principle" by posting between 9:30 PM and 11:00 PM to reach donors when they are most active online.

Part 3: Content Creation

This is AI generated from a very specific prompt I did create in my own head:

Prompt: create a 3 part reel post that has a script. I want this to be 3 characters (all played by me). the first character is a mentor (she is wearing an eye patch, and is grumpy and hates people) the second character is a "new doe eyed volunteer" who is super friendly and loves helping people and loves cats. the third character is a 80 yr old cat lady who does not understand TNR but really wants to help the cats outside on her porch, who is well-meaning but also gets in the way consistently for the two who are trapping cats.

Post One: The Briefing

Character Focus: Grumpy Mentor & Doe-Eyed Volunteer

Setting: A car filled with traps (or a living room standing in for one).

[Scene Start]

Grumpy Mentor: (Adjusts eye patch, glares at camera) Listen up, Recruit. We're hitting the North Side tonight. High kitten density. Low patience. If I see a flashlight, I'm taking it. If you talk to a human, I'm leaving you there. We are ghosts. We are the night. We are...

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: (Pops into frame with a sparkly "Cat Mom" headband) ...The besties the kitties ever had! Hi! I'm Sunny! I brought organic catnip-infused treats and I made little "Get Well Soon" cards for after their surgeries!

Grumpy Mentor: (Rubbing temples) It's a feral colony, Sunny. They don't want cards. They want the tuna. Set the trap, cover the trap, move to the next. No eye contact.

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: But what if they want a chin scratch? I have a special "meow" I've been practicing—

Grumpy Mentor: If you "meow" at a feral cat, I'm putting you in the trap. Now move. We've got 99 problems and 20 of them are un-spayed females in this alley.

[Text Overlay]: TNR Mission: Phase 1 — Deployment. 🐾

[CTA]: Part 2: Meeting the Neighborhood...

Post 2: The Obstacle

Character Focus: All Three

Setting: Outside (or near a porch/window).

[Scene Start]

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: (Whispering loudly) Look! A sweet little orange boy! He's going for the trap! He's so close—

80-Year-Old Neighbor: (Wobbles into frame holding a giant porcelain bowl) HELLO?! ARE YOU THE CAT PEOPLE? I BROUGHT THE CASSEROLE!

Grumpy Mentor: (Hissing) Get back! You're spooking him!

80-Year-Old Neighbor: (Ignoring her) I saw him looking hungry, so I put out a whole tray of tuna and some leftover lasagna. He loves the cheese! I call him "Mr. Pringles."

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: (Heart eyes) Mr. Pringles! That's so precious!

Grumpy Mentor: (To Neighbor) Ma'am, we told you no food after 6:00 PM! If he eats your lasagna, he won't go in the trap. If he doesn't go in the trap, he doesn't get fixed. If he doesn't get fixed, you're going to have 15 "Mr. Pringles Juniors" on this porch by June.

80-Year-Old Neighbor: Oh, but he looked so thin! I also put out some warm milk and a little sweater I knitted.

Grumpy Mentor: (Staring into the camera, deadpan) This is why we can't have nice things.

[Text Overlay]: Rule #1 of TNR: Stop feeding the cats before trapping night! 🛑

Post 3: The Success (and the "Ask")

Character Focus: All Three

Setting: The porch, now with a covered trap.

[Scene Start]

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: (Holding a covered trap, vibrating with joy) We got him! We got Mr. Pringles! He's going to get his shots, his surgery, and a fancy little ear-tip!

80-Year-Old Neighbor: (Wiping a tear) An ear-tip? Like a piercing? Oh, he'll be the most stylish boy in the trailer park. Does this mean he won't... you know... yell at 3 AM anymore?

Grumpy Mentor: (Softens for exactly one second) Less yelling. No more kittens. A healthier "Mr. Pringles." (Hardens again) Now, Ma'am, unless you're planning on paying the \$50 vet bill for this lasagna-eater, get back inside.

80-Year-Old Neighbor: \$50? That's less than my knitting yarn! (Points to camera) Hey, you out there! If an old lady on a fixed income can help, you can too! Give these grumpy girls some gas money!

Doe-Eyed Volunteer: (Beaming) She's right! Every \$50 spays a "Queen" and saves dozens of lives. [Link in bio!](#)

Grumpy Mentor: (Sighs, adjusts eye patch) Just click the link. Don't make me come find you.

[Final Text Overlay]: Help us fix 99 cats this month. Donate to Ozarks TNR. 

Reflection:

This is the funniest thing I have ever read in my life, and I think this is so good. I think I may deploy this idea.

Hw 17

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #17

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Instructions

Week 12 Homework 17: Mobile Fundraising Strategy

Instructions

Based on your selected nonprofit, complete the following:

Part 1: Mobile Giving Assessment

Review the organization’s current mobile fundraising presence. This may include:

- Mobile-friendly website
- Donation page on a smartphone
- Text-to-give capabilities

In 1–2 paragraphs, assess:

- Is the donation experience mobile-friendly and easy to navigate?
- How many steps does it take to complete a donation?
- Are there any barriers or frustrations from a user perspective?
- Does the organization make giving easy “in the moment”?

Part 2: Donor Experience Reflection

Put yourself in the role of a donor using your phone.

In 1 paragraph, describe:

- How the experience feels (simple, confusing, compelling, etc.)
- Whether you would complete the donation
- What might cause you to abandon the process

Part 3: Mobile Fundraising Strategy Design

Create a simple mobile fundraising strategy your nonprofit

Include:

- One mobile-specific fundraising tactic
- A brief description of how it would be used
- A clear call to action written as if speaking directly to a donor
- One idea for making the experience more donor-centered and seamless

Part 4: Key Improvement Recommendations

Provide 2–3 specific recommendations to improve the organization’s mobile fundraising effectiveness based on what you learned in Chapter 18.

Hw #18

Amber “Ber” Perhacs

Homework #18

SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising

Tim Traps Cats

Part 1: Advocacy Reflection

The nonprofit currently only engages in a more informal advocacy by educating individual residents and colony caretakers about the benefits of Trap Neuter and Return (TNR). We talk to our volunteers and those whom we help with cats about how the traditional "Catch and Kill" methods just do not work and are unnecessary suffering. We advocate for the humane treatment of unsheltered cats and dogs by providing resources such as bottle-baby kits and free vaccination clinics. These programs serve as grassroots efforts for animals living in low-income communities. However, our advocacy is largely limited to direct service and education. Although it is a major goal of ours, we have yet to engage in high-level policy advocacy with local government or municipal animal control to establish TNR as a city-wide standard in Springfield. I have been able to tour the facilities and understand the mentality and what happens behind closed doors at our animal control. I know what I want, but getting in front of the right people has been the current block in movement on this.

Part 2: Advocacy Strategy Development

The core policy area impacting our mission is the lack of a formal "TNR Ordinance" in Springfield. We currently have a very interesting approach to cats within the city. There is a limit of 4 cats per person, and that includes cats inside the home as well as cats feeding outside of the home. This is not heavily enforced due to a lack of resources. However, Springfield does take surrenders of community cats to their facility, and typically these cats will be euthanized. This includes cats who have ear tips (they have been through the TNR program). There has also been a major stigma that has painted cats as just pests due to the currently laws, which has led many community members to fear legal repercussions for feeding or trapping community cats. The outdated ordinances actually currently work against scientifically backed integrated pest management styles geared towards any domesticated mammals. If I could only get one topic completed, it would be to keep ear-tipped cats where they are; they work as population control

for an area. However, a complete plan would include advocating for a city ordinance that officially recognizes TNR as the preferred method for feline population control, protecting caretakers, and ensuring the longevity of our Ozarks TNR program.

Some of the Tactics for Engagement that I would like to look into would be joining or forming local coalitions with other animal welfare and environmental groups. This will allow us to overcome our internal capacity barriers. Nonprofits in collaborative groups advocate at significantly higher rates, and this has proven to be true when we work with other rescues; we tend to get more done, rather than isolating. We can invite City Council members and legislative staff to visit our service sites. This will allow these policymakers to hear directly from low-income residents who are the most affected by unsheltered animal populations. This will hopefully bridge the gap between decision-makers and the "on-the-ground" reality. Another way to do this is to take photos and videos, but this can sometimes be hard to effectively complete. We also will look to develop resources that translate complex municipal legal language into simple, actionable information for our board and volunteers. These trainings will help ensure that our volunteers understand what they can and cannot do as representatives for the nonprofit.

One of the ways I would like to see us expand as a nonprofit is to get board members involved who could leverage their social connections to seek introductions to local policymakers and leaders. By recruiting a board member with some more legal expertise, we can safely navigate municipal law and offer the city a ready-made policy framework that aligns with public opinions and health. The nonprofit can utilize our social media groups to help us gather testimonials from volunteers who have seen how neighborhoods are stabilized by our efforts. We will help these volunteers tell their stories to the City Council, transforming abstract policy into a real human narrative.

Part 3: Fundraising Connection

I would want to make that fundraising connection by strengthening our donor trust and opening new funding opportunities. Advocacy proves to donors that Tim Traps Cats is not just reacting to a crisis but is really working to "fix the system." This is something that is super close to my heart, but I just have struggled to make headway on this. If donors see our organization successfully influencing city policy, this will just increase their confidence that their gifts

contribute to a sustainable solution for Springfield's urban ecosystem! It helps shift our image from a small grassroots rescue to a strategic community leader.

Creating a more formal advocacy strategy will help make us eligible for higher-level funding. I have found that many private foundations specifically want to fund systems change and public health initiatives. By aligning our TNR work with urban ecology and public health policy, we can move beyond a grassroots movement and actually secure real grant funding.

final assign

Final Project: Comprehensive Fundraising Plan

This final project is your opportunity to bring together everything we have worked on throughout the course into one cohesive, strategic document. You will create a comprehensive annual fundraising plan for your selected nonprofit that reflects best practices in donor-centered fundraising, strategy, and communication.

Project Overview

You will develop a **7-page annual fundraising plan** that incorporates key components from your previous assignments throughout the course.

Your plan should demonstrate intentional strategy, alignment with mission, and a clear path to generating support.

Your plan should include an

- An overview of your organization,
- The overall fundraising goal for the nonprofit's fiscal year
- as well as fundraising goals for each appeal planned
- donor segments for appeals planned
- any specific donor-centered messaging for each appeal
- strategies being used throughout the year in your plan
- stewardship plans
- timeline for these activities, etc.

Final Project Timeline

Draft Fundraising Plan

- **Due: May 3**
- Submit your full draft (7 pages)

Peer Review

- Partner with the same classmate from your **Midterm Major Donor Ask role-play**
- Review each other's plans and provide feedback
- **Submit a 1-page peer review by May 5**

Final Fundraising Plan

- Revise your plan based on peer feedback
- Incorporate any changes you feel strengthen your Annual Fundraising Plan
- **Final submission due: May 7**

* This project is meant to reflect real-world nonprofit fundraising. Think of this as something you could confidently present to a board or development team, and as a strong example you can use when interviewing for a development or fundraising position after you graduate.

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Final Final

Amber “Ber” Perhacs
Final Fundraising Plan
SOC697 - Nonprofit Fundraising
Tim Traps Cats

Annual Fundraising Plan: Tim Traps Cats

Our nonprofit organization has hit a logistical ceiling and needs to start transitioning from a volunteer-only group to a structured entity with permanent infrastructure. The focal point of this year’s strategy will be the mobile outreach clinic capital campaign, a specific effort to fund the acquisition and outfitting of a custom-built and dual-suite mobile trailer to serve as the primary service and education location for Tim Traps Cats. We will optimize the longevity of this project by opting for a towed trailer over a motorized vehicle (RV/bus). This unique mobile clinic will provide a controlled, medical-grade environment, allowing for easy expansion as our program grows. There will be two distinct spaces with separate external doors to streamline intake and discharge. It is believed that this mobile trailer will allow us to bring essential veterinary care directly to neighborhoods in Springfield and the surrounding rural areas.

Overview of your Organization

Tim Traps Cats works to create a healthier and more balanced urban ecosystem in Springfield, Missouri, by providing resources for spay, neuter, and vaccination services for unsheltered cat and dog populations. They have two programs: Ozarks TNR and Stop Parvo MO.

Ozarks TNR aims to improve the health and number of homeless cats in the Springfield, Missouri area. By trapping, sterilizing, and returning community cats to their outdoor homes, we will work with individuals and rescues in the community, lower the number of homeless kittens born in our area, and reduce the stress on local rescue resources.

Stop Parvo is dedicated to protecting dogs in our unsheltered and extremely low-income communities by providing access to essential care and supplies. This includes but is not limited to vaccinations, nutritious food, and critical gear. Our mission is to prevent the spread of deadly

preventable illnesses. Every dog deserves a healthy life regardless of their owner's financial situation.

Mobile Outreach Clinic Capital Campaign and Need:

Since its inception in 2021, Tim Traps Cats has focused on education and equipment for community animal welfare. However, with the addition of our Stop Parvo program and the expansion of Ozarks TNR programs have reached a logistical ceiling. We have historically relied on external veterinary clinics, which creates significant transport barriers for local trappers and low-income residents. To better balance the urban ecosystem, we require a designated space to help run these programs. This trailer can be used as a mobile vaccine clinic for the Stop Parvo clinics, allowing us to reach more neighborhoods. This trailer will also provide transportation and a recovery space for feral cats going through the Ozarks TNR.

The number one problem seen is access to other low-cost options around Springfield: transportation. Caretakers in underserved areas often lack the reliable transportation required to access the low-cost options that can be a far drive for these individuals. The start-up costs that are included in investing in a new low-cost facility are beyond a realistic goal for Tim Traps Cats, since it involves high costs in property taxes and utilities. These overhead costs will just continue to drain funds from the mission we strive to make a difference in. Standard clinic layouts often lead to stress for the animals, and something like a two-chambered trailer that will only have one dog or cat patient receiving care will provide a less stressful experience. This also allows for Tim Traps Cats to get a dedicated gathering space much faster than a brick-and-mortar. This trailer can be taken to just about any meeting space and can be used as a mobile education space as well. This trailer can be the heart of the nonprofit, solving many of the problems we have previously faced with less overhead and start-up costs.

Total Yearly Fundraising Goal: \$100,000

Capital Campaign Goal: \$55,000 (Trailer acquisition, medical outfitting, and power systems)

While there are other configurations, I will provide a sample budget based on some average costs. The towed trailer model offers superior longevity compared to motorized units, as it separates the medical asset from engine liability.

Estimated Project Budget		
Item Category	Estimated Cost	Purpose for Tim Traps Cats
24ft Enclosed Trailer	\$9,500–\$13,500	Dual-axle stability; two factory-installed side doors.
HVAC & Insulation	\$4,000–\$6,500	Spray foam + 15k BTU unit with heat pump for Missouri weather.
Medical Flooring	\$1,500–\$2,500	Seamless, commercial-grade vinyl coved for sanitation.
Power System	\$6,000–\$9,000	7k-watt quiet generator and 50-amp shore power hookups.
Water & Sanitation	\$3,000–\$5,000	Dual sinks, fresh/grey water tanks, and a water heater.
Exam & Tech Suite	\$12,000–\$18,000	Folding tables, pharmacy shelving, and Starlink Wi-Fi.
<i>Estimated Total</i>	<i>\$36,000–\$54,500</i>	

Explanation for the expansion project and problem:

The construction of a 24ft Dual-Axle Custom Mobile Trailer. This "clinic on wheels" will be intentionally designed to have two separate rooms that will prioritize both human education and animal welfare. This trailer is also a project that can be expanded on. While the trailer will start as a place where we can have vaccine clinics and education events. We will also be able to be outfitted for large colonies of cats during TNR days and transport large numbers of feral cats to low-cost clinics. We can use the trailer to transport the cats and also recover them, so there is less loading and unloading of traps. The trailer can also be set up to expand into a mobile spay and neuter clinic that can work to fix community cats and dogs. This requires more advanced equipment, but the trailer will be something that can continue to grow with the nonprofit organization and expand as we receive more funding.

I think that this mobile clinic will provide many benefits to the function of the nonprofit, but also to the community as well. By having access to this clinic, we will bridge the economic gap of the long-distance transport for community pets and their caretakers, and allow us to further the reach of this mission. This mobile trailer will also provide our team with a consistent and organized space to train the next generation of animal welfare advocates in Springfield.

Annual Operations & Program Goal: \$45,000 (Spay/neuter grants, medical supplies, and outreach)

Tim Traps Cats needs to continue the outreach mission while also working towards expanding the mission. To complete both objects will will implement these fundraising strategies.

Fundraising Calendar

Date	Campaign Name	Goal	Donor Segment
March 15	Spring Kitten Appeal (direct mail/ social media/ events)	\$10,000	Past donors: local Springfield residents
May 10	We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one. (email/social media/events)	\$5,000	Lapsed donors; monthly one-time givers
Sept 20	Alley-Cat 5K (Peer-to-Peer)	\$50,000	Millennials, Gen Z, local businesses
Nov 25	Year-End Capital Campaign Push	\$35,000	Major donors, Board of Directors prospects

Fundraising Plan

1. Direct Mail: The Spring Kitten Appeal
 - a. Fundraise for the upcoming "Kitten Season" medical supplies for bottle baby kits and puppy parvo prevention shots. This push will help fund vaccines for puppies

at the free outreach clinic and bottle baby kits distributed to shelters this time of year. Use this direct mail to also post about the capital campaign and how donors can choose to donate towards expanding the mission or helping the animals directly. This will help fund some of the major activities that we offer to the community. We hope that by dropping this mailer just as the spring and baby season begins, we can ensure that we will have liquidity to purchase bottle baby kits and vaccination supplies before the highest influx of vulnerable animals arrives. It also allows donors to start to see some of the problems that exist and allows them to take some action instead of being bystanders in this large community problem.

- b. Donor Segments: This appeal will target empathetic residents who witness the influx of kittens in their own backyards and want immediate, tangible solutions.
 - c. Donor Specific messaging: "Kitten season is coming, but you don't have to be a bystander. Your gift of \$50 today provides a life-saving bottle-baby kit, ensuring these abandoned newborns have a fighting chance."
 - d. Stewardship Tie-in: Receive photos/postcards of the kittens their kits saved or puppies that were vaccinated
2. Email: We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one.
- a. I find this email and social media campaign to be light-hearted in a drowning, sad industry; it can help spark some conversations while also educating our donor bases. This is a time to touch base with our donors and let them know how close we are to our capital campaign goal for expansion, and touch base with how many vaccinations and how much outreach we have completed so far this year.
 - b. Donor Segments: This appeal will target those who will respond well to light-hearted, high-energy content that breaks the "sad" mold of typical rescue appeals.
 - c. Donor Specific messaging: Spring is just around the corner, and in the world of cat rescue, that means one thing: thousands of homeless kittens! The season is coming as it does every year, and our shelters are already overwhelmed. It doesn't have to be this way. With your support, Ozarks TNR can help relieve this yearly problem. We know that the most effective way to help is through the management

project called: Trap-Neuter-Return (TNR). We are launching our " We have 99 problems, but a Queen ain't one." That will help fix 99 community cats in the next 30 days. This proactive effort will prevent thousands of unwanted births in Springfield and the surrounding area. We have the traps and the volunteers, we just need the funding!

- d. Stewardship Tie-in: We will allow for donors to name neutered cats in releasing videos that mention their name and namer (if they want)
3. The "Alley-Cat" 5K & Peer-to-Peer Run/Walk/Ride
- a. This event is a great way to really gain funds towards our expansion project without seeming like we are taking too many funds away from the animals and people in need of our outreach services.
 - b. A family-friendly 5K run/walk and a 10-mile bicycle ride through downtown Springfield, MO, passing through areas where Tim Traps Cats has managed community cat colonies. This event leverages the local urban ecosystem to help build a sense of pride and community accomplishment. I think it would be fun to run this as a large group event with a tour guide who can talk about all the local urban biodiversity and point out fun finds on the ride. I also think that we can accomplish this within a detailed map with literature on each location as well, but a tour guide just makes it more interactive, personal, and different.
 - c. Donor Segment: This event will target family friend folk who value fitness, community pride, and transparency.
 - d. Donor Specific messaging: "Run, walk, or ride for the cats you've saved. See the Springfield urban ecosystem in action and learn the stories behind the colonies we manage together". This is a great time to use an interactive tour guide to talk about Springfield's urban biodiversity while passing through neighborhoods with community cats.
 - e. Stewardship Tie-in: We will provide participants with a digital map showing the colonies they passed during the race.
4. Mobile Outreach Center Capital Campaign
- a. "Would you consider a leadership gift to help us secure a medical-grade suite that eliminates the transportation barrier for Springfield's most vulnerable animals?"

- b. Shifting from reactive "Catch and Kill" models to science-based population management, and hopefully gaining the support of the city for these efforts.
- c. Donor Segment: This campaign will focus on Major givers/ donors who are interested in tangible community stabilization and long-term fiscal responsibility.
- d. Donor Specific messaging:” Would you consider a leadership gift to help us secure a medical-grade suite that eliminates the transportation barrier for Springfield's most vulnerable animals?" Shifting from reactive "Catch and Kill" models to science-based population management, and hopefully gaining the support of the city for these efforts.
- e. Fun Note: I have a 15k ready to “match donations” for this campaign, locked in and ready to go for when this launches.
- f. Stewardship Tie-in: Donors can opt in to receive a personal tour of the trailer layout for a special ribbon-cutting event tailored to celebrate with those who gave to this project.

CRM Platform

We will be using Zeffy as our CRM platform. We plan to take the attendees from the various events we attend and any of the social media campaigns that help collect emails and addresses for emailing. We will use this information to integrate them into our donor software. All event registration data will be synced with existing donor profiles. We believe that using Zeffy's fee-free model will help legitimize ourselves for your major donors, for the later push for expansion. Zeffy really shows our donors that *"Every penny of your \$1,000 gift buys medical equipment."*

This software will be utilized the most when hosting the "Alley-Cat" 5K & Peer-to-Peer Run/Walk/Ride. Anyone who gets flagged as a new participant will have a note added to their profile as "Prospectful Donors" for our organization. Based on their registration choices, we will make notes in their donor profile to say if they are more likely to support our dog or cat programs. To maintain financial transparency and analyze the event's return on investment, all incoming donations will be coded under the "Alley-Cat 5K" solicitation code to know where these potential donors were sourced.

Conclusion

Tim Traps Cats focuses on the critical \$55,000 required for the mobile trailer while maintaining \$45,000 for direct outreach that goes to the programs that already exist. This plan ensures we remain an outreach operation, while we are also funding for our expansion. We hope that this plan will help Tim Traps Cats to provide high-level veterinary care that Springfield's unsheltered populations require.

AI Transparency

I utilized AI to assist in the drafting of this Fundraising plan. I used AI to help digest the task and guide the letter in a way that most people can digest more easily, while also applying a professional tone. I used the AI to help create a more donor-centered narrative that uses a more logistical tone than one focused on emotion, while also engaging in some storytelling and pushing for a community partnership. I walked through this entire document and added a more personalized touch to match my personal voice and leadership style, and removed the obvious AI traits that I find to be unprofessional. I also want to ensure the letter accurately reflects the specific programs of Tim Traps Cats and our work with the unsheltered community in Springfield, MO